MAWENZI ADVENTURES

USEFUL SWAHILI WORDS AND PHRASES FOR TRAVELERS

GREETINGS & INTRODUCTIONS

How are you/things?	Jambo?	**Fine**	Jambo
	Hujambo? (singular)	**I'm fine**	Sijambo
	Hamjambo? (plural)	**We are fine**	Hatujambo
What's your news?	Habari?	**Fine**	Nzuri / safi
		Peaceful	Salama
What's up?	Mambo?	**Cool**	Poa
	Vipi?	**Fine**	Nzuri / safi
	(only for young people)	**Peaceful**	Salama
Greeting an older person	Shikamoo	**Response from older person**	Marahaba
Are you healthy?	Mzima?	**I'm healthy**	Mzima
What's your name?	Unaitwa nani?	**My name is...**	Ninaitwa ...
	Jina lako nani?		Jina langu ni ...
Where are you from?	Unatoka wapi?	**I come from...**	Ninatoka…
How old are you?	Una miaka mingapi?	**I'm ... years old**	Nina miaka …
Nice to meet you	Ninafuraha kukutana nawe		
Goodbye	Kwaheri		
(See you) later!	(Tutaonana) baadaye		
Good day (as goodbye)	Siku njema		
Good evening (as goodbye)	Jioni njema		
Good night (as goodbye)	Usiku mwema		
Sleep well	Lala salama		

COURTESIES & (DIS)AGREEMENTS

Yes	Ndiyo	**Do you understand?**	Unaelewa?
No	Hapana	**I understand**	Naelewa
OK	Sawa	**I don't understand**	Sielewi
Thank you	Ahsante (to 1 person)	**I don't speak Swahili**	Siongei Kiswahili
	Ahsanteni (to more than 1 person)	**Could you repeat?**	Sema tena
(You're) welcome	Karibu (to 1 person)	**Do you speak English?**	Unaongea Kiingereza?
	Karibuni (to more than 1 person)	**A little bit**	Kidogo
No, thank you	Hapana ahsante	**Slowly**	Pole pole
Please	Tafadhali	**Please write it down for me**	Naomba uniandikie
Can I please get …	Naomba	**Do you like …?**	Unapenda …?
Excuse me	Samahani	**I like …**	Napenda …
Sorry	Pole	**I don't like …**	Sipendi …
… very much	… sana (eg. ahsante sana, …)	**Do you know …?**	Unajua …?
No worries	Hakuna matata	**I know …**	Najua …
No problem	Hamna shida	**I don't know …**	Sijui …

MAWENZI ADVENTURES

PRONOUNS & PEOPLE

Me	Mimi	**We**	Sisi
You	Wewe	**You (plural)**	Ninyi
He/she	Yeye	**They**	Wao
Woman	Mwanaume (pl. wanawake)	**Man**	Mwanaume (pl. wanaume)
Mother	Mama	**Father**	Baba
Miss, misses	Mama	**Mister**	Bwana
Grandmother	Bibi	**Grandfather**	Babu
Sister	Dada (also for a sister from another mister)		
Brother	Kaka (also for a brother from another mother)		
Friend	Rafiki		
Child	Mtoto		

QUESTIONS

What?	Nini?	**Where?**	Wapi?
Who?	Nani?	**When?**	Lini?
Why?	Kwa nini?	**How many?**	Ngapi?
Because …	Kwa sababu	**Which? / What kind of?**	Gani?

NUMBERS

One	Moja	**One hundred**	Mia moja
Two	Mbili	**Two hundred**	Mia mbili
Three	Tatu	**…**	…
Four	Nne	**One thousand**	Elfu moja
Five	Tano	**Two thousand**	Elfu mbili
Six	Sita	**…**	…
Seven	Saba	**Ten thousand**	Elfu kumi
Eight	Nane	**Twenty thousand**	Elfu ishirini
Nine	Tisa	**…**	…
Ten	Kumi	**One hundred thousand**	Laki moja
Eleven	Kumi na moja	**Two hundred thousand**	Laki mbili
Twelve	Kumi na mbili	**…**	…
…	…	**One million**	Millioni moja
Twenty	Ishirini	**Two million**	Millioni mbili
Thirty	Thelathini	**…**	…
Fourty	Arobaini	**Half**	Nusu
Fifty	Hamsini	**Quarter**	Robo
Sixty	Sitini	**Minus**	Kasoro
Seventy	Sabini	**Plus / and**	Na
Eighty	Themanini	**Precisely**	Kamili
Ninety	Tisini		

TIME & DATE

To speak about time in Swahili, you use 'saa' (hour) and then combine the numbers above. The only difficulty is that **Swahili time is counted differently than time in most other places in the world**, as it's based on sunrise and sunset and not on noon and midnight. Being located close to the equator, of course sunrise and sunset in Tanzania occur around the same time every day of the year. There's a difference of 6 hours, so 0 hours isn't at midnight, but at 6 am. 5.45 pm would be saa kumi na mbili kasoro robo jioni (12 hours (6 + 6) minus a quarter in the evening).

Please realize that Tanzanians are generally less strict about time than Europeans or Américains. This isn't considered rude, especially in situations that aren't work-related but even in those, it's normal. Our guides and staff members are of course aware that timings need to be respected when dealing with our clients, but other people you meet might not be this precise. If you want to accentuate to somebody that they should be on time, you can use the word 'kamili', eg. saa moja asubuhi kamili means 7 am precisely, or use 'naomba usichelewe', meaning 'please don't be late'.

Hour	Saa	**Today**	Leo
Minute	Dakika	**Tomorrow**	Kesho
Second	Sekunde	**Yesterday**	Jana
What time is it?	Saa ngapi?	**Day after tomorrow**	Kesho kutwa
When?	Lini?	**Day before yesterday**	Juzi
Morning	Asubuhi (from 7 am to 11.59 am)	**Date**	Tarahe
(After)noon	Mchana (from 12 pm to 3.59 pm)	**Day**	Siku
Evening	Jioni (from 4 pm to 6.59 pm)	**Week**	Wiki
Night	Usiku (from 7 pm to 6.59 am)	**Month**	Mwezi
Now	Sasa	**Year**	Mwaka
Soon	Sasa hivi	**Monday**	Jumatatu
Later	Baadaye	**Tuesday**	Jumanne
Before …	Kabla ya …	**Wednesday**	Jumatano
After …	Baada ya …	**Thursday**	Alhamisi
Previous / ago	Iliyopita	**Friday**	Ijumaa
Next	Ijayo	**Saturday**	Jumamosi
Early	Mapema	**Sunday**	Jumapili

SHOPPING & PAYING

Shop	Duka	**Which?**	Gani?
Market	Soko	**Which price?**	Bei gani?
Price	Bei		Shi ngapi? (how many shillings?)
Money	Hela	**Cheap**	Rahisi
Cash money	Pesa	**Expensive**	Ghali
Do you sell … ?	Unauza … ?	**That's a good price**	Bei inafaa
I want to buy …	Nataka kununua …	**Please reduce the price**	Naomba upunguze bei
How much/many? (general)	Ngapi?	**I have a card**	Nina kadi
More	Zaidi	**I'm only looking**	Naangalia tu
Less	Kidogo zaidi	**I don't need …**	Sihitaji …
		I want to change money	Nataka kubadilisha pesa

MAWENZI ADVENTURES

ACCOMMODATION

I'm looking for…	Ninatafuta…
A (cheap) hotel	Hoteli (rahisi)
A hostel	Hosteli
Where is it?	Iko wapi?
Do you have a room available?	Kuna chumba kinapatikana?
What's the price per night?	Ni bei gani kwa usiku?
What's the price per person?	Ni bei gani kwa mtu mmoja?
Please show me the room	Naomba nionyeshe chumba
I'll take the room	Nitachukua chumba
Is breakfast included?	Je, chumba kitakuwa na chakula cha asubuhi?
Breakfast is included	Chakula cha asubuhi kinapatikana
I want to wash my clothes	Nataka kufua nguo zangu
Please wash my clothes	Naomba unifulie nguo zangu
I want to stay until…	Nataka kukaa mpaka …
I want to stay … nights	Nataka kukaa usiku …
I'm leaving today	Ninaondoka leo
Room	Chumba (pl. vyumba)
Bed	Kitanda (pl. vitanda)
Bathroom	Bafu
Toilet	Choo (pl. vyoo)
Hot/cold water	Maji moto/baridi

FOOD & DRINKS

Menu	Menu
Bill	Bili
I would like…	Naomba…
The bill, please	Naomba bili
	Naomba kulipa (I'd like to pay)
I'm hungry	Nahisi njaa
I'm thirsty	Nina kiu
The food is very good	Chakula kiko kitamu sana
I'm full	Nimechiba
It's enough	Inatosha
Please give me more	Naomba niongeze
Food	Chakula
Breakfast	Chakula cha asubuhi
Lunch	Chakula cha mchana
Dinner	Chakula cha jioni
To eat / I eat	Kula / ninakula
Drink	Kinywaji (pl. vinywaji)
(Drinking) water	Maji (ya kunywa)
Juice	Juice
Tea	Chai
Coffee	Kahawa
Milk	Maziwa
Soup	Supu
Beer	Bia
Cold	Baridi
Warm	Moto
Big	Kubwa
Small	Ndogo
Or	Au
Meat	Nyama (often used for beef)
Beef	Nyama ya ng'ombe
Chicken	Kuku
Fish	Samaki
Goat	Mbuzi
Grilled	Choma (eg. nyama choma)
Meat skewers	Mishkaki
Sauce	Mchuzi (eg. kuku mchuzi)
Rice	Wali
Ugali	Local dish made from corn flour
Chapati	Local 'tortilla' made from corn flour
Vegetables	Mboga mboga
Fruits	Matunda
Avocado	Parachichi
Mango	Embe (pl. maembe)
Pineaple	Nanasi
Orange	Chungwa (pl. machungwa)
Banana	Ndizi
Watermelon	Tikiti maji
Green pepper	Pilipili hoho
Carrot	Karoti
Tomato	Nyanya
Onion	Kitunguu (pl. vitunguu)
Potato	Kiazi (pl. viazi)
Cucumber	Tango (pl. matango)
I don't eat …	Sili …
But I do eat …	Lakini nakula …
Without	Bila

MAWENZI ADVENTURES

TRANSPORT, PLACES & DIRECTIONS

Where?	Wapi?
Where is … ?	… iko wapi?
Trip, journey	Safari
Have a safe trip	Safari njema!
I want to go to…	Nataka kwenda …
Road	Barabara
Are you on the way?	Uko njiani?
I'm on the way	Niko njiani
We've arrived	Tumefika
Straight forward	Moja kwa moja
A little bit futher (forward)	Mbele
To the right	Kwa kulia
To the left	Kwa kushoto
Backwards	Kwa nyuma
Far	Mbali
Nearby	Karibu
Close to …	Karibu na …
Here	Hapa
There	Pale

Car / vehicle	Gari
Taxi	Teksi
Bus	Basi
Minibus	Daladala
Train	Treni
Tuktuk	Bajaji
Motorbike taxi	Bodaboda
Bicycle	Baiskeli
Airplane	Ndege
What time does the … leave?	… inaondoka saa ngapi?
Is there a … going to…?	Kuna … kwenda …?
I want to get off here	Nataka kushuka hapa
Fare	Nauli
Ticket	Tikiti
Busstand	Bas stendi
Airport	Uwanja wa ndege
Beach	Pwani
Ocean	Bahari

OFFICIAL MATTERS & EMERGENCIES

Help!	Msaada!
Please help me	Naomba msaada
I've had an accident	Nimepata ajali
I am lost	Nimepotea
Please call …	Naomba upigie …
I've been robbed	Nimeibiwa
I've lost my …	Nimepotesa … yangu
My … got stolen	Nimeibiwa …
Police	Polisi
Police station	Kituo cha polisi
Please leave me alone	Naomba niache pekeyangu
Go away (strong)	Toka!
Stop!	Acha!

Passport	Passporti
Cellphone	Simu
Bag	Begi
Key	Ufunguo
Name	Jina
Nationality	Utaifa
Birthday	Siku ya kuzaliwa
Place of birth	Mahali pa kuzaliwa
Gender	Jinsia
Male	Wa kiume
Female	Wa kike
Danger!	Hatari!

HEALTH

Hospital	Hospitali
Doctor	Daktari (pl. madaktari)
I'm sick	Mimi ni mgonjwa
This (point to spot) hurts	Hii inaumiza
I have diarrhea	Nina hara
I have a fever	Nina homa
I have a cold	Nina mafua
Medicine	Dawa
Pharmacy	Duka la dawa
Painkiller	Painkiller
Antiseptic	Antiseptiki
I have asthma	Nina pumu
I have epilepsy	Nina kifafa
I have diabetis	Nina ugonjwa wa sukari
I'm allergic to …	Siwezi kutumia …. Nina aleji.
Antibiotics	Antibiotics
Aspirine	Aspirini
Nuts	Karanga
Gluten	Gluten
Diary	Shajara

The phrases and words in this document are meant to be used by travelers to get by during their stay in Tanzania. It is in no way a full Swahili curriculum and simply combining the mentioned words into sentences will for sure lead to some grammatical and other mistakes but most people should understand what you mean.